

Docker

Build images, run containers, wire up Compose, and clean up after.

[GitHub ↗](#)

Images ▼

The commands you reach for daily with the Docker CLI. `docker compose` (v2, a subcommand) has replaced the old `docker -compose` binary — both are shown where they differ.

IMAGES

COMMAND	ACTION
<code>docker build -t app:1.0 .</code>	build an image from the Dockerfile here
<code>docker images</code>	list local images
<code>docker pull nginx:alpine</code>	download an image
<code>docker tag app:1.0 app:latest</code>	add another tag
<code>docker push registry/app:1.0</code>	upload to a registry
<code>docker rmi app:1.0</code>	remove an image

CONTAINERS

COMMAND	ACTION
<code>docker run nginx</code>	run a container in the foreground
<code>docker ps</code>	list running containers
<code>docker ps -a</code>	list all containers, including stopped
<code>docker stop <id></code>	graceful stop (SIGTERM)
<code>docker start / restart <id></code>	start / restart a container
<code>docker rm <id></code>	remove a stopped container
<code>docker exec -it <id> sh</code>	open a shell inside a running container
<code>docker logs -f <id></code>	follow a container's logs

COMMON RUN FLAGS

FLAG	EFFECT
<code>-d</code>	detached — run in the background
<code>-p 8080:80</code>	map host port 8080 to container port 80
<code>-v ./data:/app/data</code>	bind-mount a host folder
<code>-e KEY=value</code>	set an environment variable
<code>--name web</code>	give the container a stable name
<code>--rm</code>	auto-remove the container when it exits
<code>--network mynet</code>	attach to a user-defined network

A typical one-liner

```
docker run -d --name web --rm \
  -p 8080:80 -v ./html:/usr/share/nginx/html \
```

nginx:alpine

COMPOSE

COMMAND	ACTION
<code>docker compose up -d</code>	start the stack in the background
<code>docker compose down</code>	stop and remove the stack
<code>docker compose ps</code>	list the stack's containers
<code>docker compose logs -f</code>	follow logs for all services
<code>docker compose build</code>	rebuild service images
<code>docker compose restart <svc></code>	restart one service

CLEAN UP DESTRUCTIVE

COMMAND	REMOVES
<code>docker system df</code>	show what Docker is using (safe)
<code>docker container prune</code>	all stopped containers
<code>docker image prune</code>	dangling (untagged) images
<code>docker image prune -a</code>	all images not used by a container
<code>docker volume prune</code>	unused volumes
<code>docker system prune -a</code>	containers, networks, and unused images



prune deletes without asking twice. `docker volume prune` can wipe database data living in an unused volume, and `system prune -a` removes every image no running container references. Check `docker system df` first.